

Google steps up

Google wants to get serious in cloud computing and here is all it is doing to achieve more. <http://dgit.in/GCloudHire>



More Pink now?

After iPhone and Apple watch, Apple to launch Beats headphones in Rose gold colour now. <http://dgit.in/BeatsRG>



DESIGN AND USABILITY

NORTON

Redesigning its layout from last year, it has a very clean and minimal look. The first screen shows the status, pulling that down will start a scan. Swiping to the left gives you the app security screen and swipe more to browse through screens of Web protection, System tuning features, license screen etc.

During testing the Anti-theft features, it seemed to locate the phone quite accurately and the other options to send SMS commands, lock, wipe, take a sneak peak, ring etc. performed as configured, too. Similar to others, Norton can be given device administrator rights to prevent from uninstallation by anyone.

KASPERSKY

Coming to its design, we really loved the interface, minimalistic but not losing out on shortcuts on the same time. It has the phone status indicator on top that takes up almost all the screen followed by just three mini icons providing options of scan, update and browser. But, when you pull up the menu it reveals more such options and settings for you like phone tracker, call filter, etc. The call and text filter was only supported for Android 4.4 or below. To safeguard against unauthorised use it offers unique features. Basic safe browsing and adblock ability need to be fixed as they didn't seem to function very well.

TREND MICRO

Home screen of this app is like a menu showcasing all the functionalities it has to offer.

Most of the features either work in background and alert you only when they need attention. You may want to hide the notification icon from within the app as Trend Micro creates notifications just about anything and everything. The privacy scan results showed widely used apps like Instagram, Snapchat affecting my privacy issues.

Something interesting that we came across while using this app is the feature to merge accounts and transfer licences across platforms and across different email ids. Very unique.

ANDROID Vs. iOS

We tested both Android and iOS version of the security apps. We couldn't help but notice the limited app support as well as features on the iOS platform. In Android where there was option to select between deep scan and quick scan, iOS doesn't even have a basic scan functionality. While the Android app suggested ways to optimise your mobile for maximum performance, iOS suffered from lack of a single integrated UI. For iOS even the activation of the apps made us scratch our heads in frustration, because the process couldn't have been any more difficult. This all can be considered power of a fully optimized OS, which Apple is so confident won't need any third party apps to optimize or the reluctance of developers to develop anti-viruses for iOS. But breaking the Apple belief that they have it all, this comparison is an evidence that Apple's platform is too restrictive.

VERDICT

The **Best Performer Award** goes to Norton Antivirus for Android. The total scan time

was quite low and it did pretty well in our real-time protection test and scores were a good

indicative of this result. Also, Norton was the only antivirus to provide very comprehensive parental control options via the Norton Family PC client.

The **Best Buy Award** goes to the Trend Micro Antivirus for Android as it offers the most features and ease of access out of all the three. It loses to Norton just by a margin on the performance scale, as it is a little heavy on the resources.

Kaspersky for Android was nowhere near the performance

mark of its other two counterpart. On the feature side, the first major issue was the non-availability of iOS app. The other two apps, however minimalistic, had an iOS app. Then, the availability of a call & text filter only for devices running Android 4.4 & below didn't make any sense to us. All in all Kaspersky managed to impress us based on its UI alone, but it was too little.

We refrained from awarding anyone Editor's Pick because we tested just three products. **4**



NORTON

PROS:

- App advisor
- Light on resources

CONS:

- No system tuning
- No support for free version

TREND MICRO

PROS:

- License Transfer
- System Tuning

CONS:

- Resource hungry
- Weak web scanner in iOS